

Unit 2 Office Correspondence and Professional Skills

2.1 Email writing

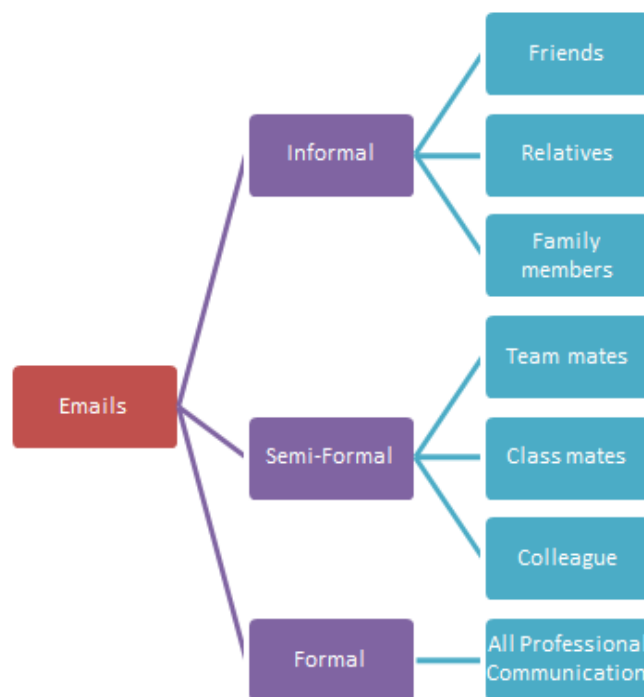
Email Writing

Email stands for electronic mail. In today's world, email is the most common form of communication. Email writing helps us to get the solution instantaneously. Email writing involves composing, sending, storing and receiving messages over an electronic communication system. An email stands for an electronic mail. Email writing is preferred over other forms of communication as it is cheaper and faster.

Types of Emails:

Emails are of three types:

1. Informal email
2. Semi-Formal email
3. Formal email



Informal Email

An informal email is written to any relatives, family or friends. There are no particular rules for informal email writing. A person can use any language of his or her choice.

Semi-Formal Email

An email written for a colleague or a team-mate within a project comes under this category. The language used is simple, friendly, and casual. Modesty and dignity must be maintained.

Formal Email

Suppose we are writing or composing an email for any type of business communication. It will come under the category of formal email. Formal email writing will be an email written to companies, government departments, school authorities or any other officers and executives.

Email Writing Format

The email writing format is the same for each of the categories. Though the choice of words and language differ depending upon the type of email. One can use friendly and casual language in informal emails. The language used in formal emails should be professional, clear, and formal.

The email writing format is:

From: Sender's email id
To: Recipient's email id
Cc: Other individuals receiving the same mail with visible ids
Bcc: Other individuals receiving the same mail with invisible ids
Subject: Title or the reason of writing mail
Salutation: Words like Dear, Respected, Hi etc.
Main body: the main content of the email 1. Introduction 2. Matter in detail 3. Conclusion
Closing: Ending Statement
Attachments: Attached Files with emails
Signature Line: Sender's name, signature, and other details of contact

Advantages of Email Writing:

- It is a cheaper form of communication.
- Email helps to contact or send information to a large group of people.
- It provides a written record of the communication.
- Email writing is an instantaneous form of communication.
- It can be used anytime and anywhere.

Disadvantages of Email Writing:

- We need to have the internet to receive or send emails
- Viruses are easily spread via email attachments
- One can get many junk emails
- There is no guarantee if the reader reads the email or not
- The details can be used for identity theft

Effective Email Writing:

There are some ways in which one can improve the way of email writing. To write a good email we must remember some points.

- Write a meaningful subject line
- Keep the message focused and understanding
- Identify yourself clearly
- Use official id for business-related or professional emails
- Use short sentences for clear convey of the message
- Organize the content of the mail in a logical and systematic manner
- Be kind

- Don't lose your focus
- Use separate paragraphs for stating different points
- Use proper, simple, polite, and clear language
- Show respect and restraint
- Make sure the message is complete
- Proofread
- Find the difference between formal and informal situations
- Respond promptly

Dos and Don'ts for writing an effective email:

Do's	Don'ts
Make points about information	Use colored fonts and different font styles for making eye-catching emails
Include graphs, flow charts, and other files as attachments	Writing emails has no format
Be kind	Make the mail as long as possible for a clear understanding of the content
Check grammar and spelling	Use any language of interest for business communication
	Write the entire mail in capital letters
	Use emoticons in professional email for expressing your emotions

Solved Example on email writing

Sample:1 Informal Email

Suppose you have to write an email to your friend inviting him or her to your birthday party.

To: XYZ

CC/BCC:

Subject: Invitation to a birthday party

Hi XYZ!

Hope this mail finds you in the best of your time. I am very happy to invite you to my birthday party on Nov 03 at ABC Hotel from 7:00 pm to 10:00 pm. The theme of the birthday party is 'Pirate of the Caribbean'.

It would be great if you come and join us at the party. We will have a great time and fun together.
See You Soon

Allen

Sample: 2 Semi-formal Email

Writing a letter to inform your classmates regarding intra-college quiz competition.

To: XYZ

CC/BCC:

Subject: Intra-college Quiz Competition.

Hello Everyone!

This is to inform you guys that an intra-college quiz competition is going to be held in our college on Nov 25 from 11:30 am in Hall – 01.

Everyone is therefore asked to take part in the competition so that our department can win. For further queries, feel free to contact me.

Thanks

LMN

(Class Representative)

Sample: 3 Formal Email

A letter of resignation to the boss.

To: XYZ

CC/BCC:

Subject: Resignation Letter

Dear Sir,

Please accept this mail as a notice that I am leaving my position with this organization. As per the norm of the company I've to give a month's notice before resigning. I hope you will get a good replacement for me within this time period.

I really appreciate the opportunities that I have been given to help me grow. Wish you and the company the best in the future.

Please let me know what to expect as far as my final work schedule and the employee benefits.

Please let me know in case of any assistance for the above.

Kindly look into the matter.

Thanks and Regards

LMN
(Project Head)

EXERCISES: 1 using the following phrases, write Thank You email for the Interview.

Thank you - time and consideration -extended - interview with you yesterday - opportunity - my experience
- my future goals - hearing from you - wish to thank – courtesy

The image shows a screenshot of an email composition window in Microsoft Outlook. The window has a light blue header bar with the following buttons from left to right: Send (with an envelope icon), Attach (with a paperclip icon), Save Draft (with a floppy disk icon), Spelling (with a checkmark and 'abc' icon), and Cancel (with a red X icon). On the far right of the header bar are three small icons: a blue envelope, a blue speech bubble with an exclamation mark, and a blue mobile phone icon.

Below the header bar are three text input fields:

- To:** A text input field with a 'Show BCC' link to its right.
- Cc:** A text input field.
- Subject:** A text input field with a 'Plain Text' link to its right.

Below the input fields is a formatting toolbar with the following elements from left to right:

- A font face dropdown menu showing 'Arial'.
- A font size dropdown menu showing '12'.
- Buttons for Bold (B), Italic (I), Underline (U), and Text Color (T with a color box).
- A button for Background Color (a pencil icon).
- A button for Insert Image (a picture icon).
- A button for Insert Link (a chain link icon).
- A button for Insert Unlink (a chain link with a slash icon).
- A button for Bulleted List (three horizontal lines with a dot).
- A button for Numbered List (three horizontal lines with numbers).
- A button for Indent (two arrows pointing right).
- A button for Outdent (two arrows pointing left).
- A button for Insert Table (a table icon).

The main body of the email is a large, empty white rectangular area for composing the message.

EXERCISES: 2 write an email to the class teacher for granting sick leave.

This is a screenshot of an email composition window. At the top, there is a toolbar with icons for Send, Attach, Save Draft, Spelling, and Cancel. Below this are three input fields: 'To:', 'Cc:', and 'Subject:'. To the right of the 'To:' field is a 'Show BCC' link, and to the right of the 'Subject:' field is a 'Plain Text' link. Below the input fields is a rich text editor toolbar with options for font face (Arial), font size (12), bold (B), italic (I), underline (U), text color, background color, text background color, bulleted list, numbered list, and indent. The main body of the email is a large, empty white area for writing the message.

EXERCISES: 3 write an email to the manager for scheduling a meeting for an upcoming project of the company.

This is a screenshot of an email composition window, identical in layout to the one above. It features a toolbar at the top with Send, Attach, Save Draft, Spelling, and Cancel buttons. Below are the 'To:', 'Cc:', and 'Subject:' input fields, with 'Show BCC' and 'Plain Text' links to their right. A rich text editor toolbar is positioned below the input fields, offering options for font (Arial), size (12), bold, italic, underline, text and background colors, and list creation. The main body is a large, empty white area for composing the email.